

Finals Essay Task 1.
Assessment on your Understanding as to what really matters to
become Data Analysts.
And How to integrate SQL into your Data Analysis

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Instruction:

Following the video that you have watch and article that I ask you to read please answer the ff: question using your own words in 2-3 sentences based on the provided source material.

1. What are the four primary factors that will differentiate a data analyst candidate in 2026?

- The four primary factors are domain knowledge, understanding the Technical ecosystem, soft skills that matter, and a strong reason why. These factors will differentiate a data analyst candidate in 2026.

2. How does domain knowledge provide a competitive advantage over purely technical candidates?

- It provides a competitive advantage because it gives a deeper understanding of the metrics, customers, stakeholders, and business dynamics specific to that field. Those with relevant background experience in areas like sales, operations, marketing, or finance are considered more valuable to employers because they already grasp the practical context behind the data.

3. What is the "lean tech stack" recommended for a foundational data analyst role?

- The lean tech stack recommended for a foundational data analyst role are Excel, SQL, and Tableau/Power BI. Python is not included because it is rarely tested in interviews or used in everyday work of data analysts.

4. Distinguish between "learning projects" and "showing projects."

- Learning projects is low pressure practice, uses one tool at a time, uses clean Kaggle datasets, and it focus on fundamentals. While showing projects answers real business questions, uses messy data, uses tools as a system, and demonstrates your storytelling skills.

5. According to the roadmap, why is Python often deprioritized for mid-career data analyst positions?

- Python is not included because it is rarely tested in interviews or used in everyday work of data analysts. Also stakeholders cannot understand python code or output.

Questions on SQL-Base on the Article Posted

6. Why is establishing the "Business Context" essential for an analyst? What is a Business Context?

- Business context means understanding what the data represents and why it exists. It is essential because it helps analysts ask the right questions and produce meaningful insights.

7. According to the text, how does SQL function as a "flashlight"?

- SQL acts like a flashlight by helping users explore and reveal what is inside the data. It allows beginners to spot patterns, errors, and unusual values step by step.

8. Why is the validation step considered a professional necessity rather than an optional task?

- Validation is a professional necessity because it ensures the data is accurate before analysis. Without it, results can be misleading and damage credibility.

9. What defines "good SQL" according to the author's standards?

- Good SQL is defined as being easy to read, explain, and trust. It focuses on clarity rather than complexity.

10. Describe the fundamental mindset shift required to move from being a student to being an analyst.

- The mindset shift is moving from writing queries to solving business problems. An analyst focuses on answering questions, not just creating SQL code.